

Quantifiers

GRAMMAR

LEVEL
Intermediate

NUMBER
EN_BE_3120G

LANGUAGE
English





Goals

- Can explain the difference between countable and uncountable nouns, with examples.
- Can accurately select the correct quantifier for a range of straightforward sentences.



a lot/a big amount

Do you spend **a great deal of** time working on your English?

We should take **a little** time every day to learn vocabulary.

Today, I'm spending a great deal of time working on my English.



Preview and warm-up

- In this lesson, we're going to practise using **quantifiers**.
- We use **quantifiers** to express the **amount there is of something**.



I have **a lot of** work to do.





Countable and uncountable nouns

- Remember that nouns are either countable or uncountable.
- **Countable nouns** can be singular and plural – *job* and *jobs*.
- **Uncountable nouns** only have one form – *work*.



I have a few jobs to do later.

I have a bit of work to do tonight.





Countable and uncountable nouns

Organise these words into countable and uncountable nouns.

furniture

room

information

car

cloud

traffic

chair

weather

a cloud

Cloud -- one cloud

Information is everywhere nowadays.

Wine is made from grapes.

• Countable

room	car	cloud
chair		

• Uncountable

<u>furniture</u>	<u>information</u>
	<u>traffic</u>
<u>weather</u>	



Countable and uncountable nouns

a bottle of water, two bottles of water.

a glass of beer, two glasses of beer/wine/juice

1. We can use numbers with uncountable nouns

☐☒

2. We can use a/an with countable nouns

☒☐

3. Drinks are normally uncountable

water, beer, wine, juice

☒☐

4. We can use some and any with countable nouns

☒☐

5. We ~~cannot~~ use some and any with uncountable nouns

☐☒

6. You ~~cannot~~ use uncountable nouns without determiners

☐☒

uncountable



Large quantities – countable and uncountable nouns

- Some **quantifiers** can be used with both **countable** and **uncountable nouns**.
- We can use **a lot of** and **lots of** to describe large quantities of both types of noun.



You have a lot of nice furniture.

The classroom needs lots of chairs.





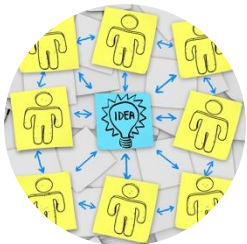
Large quantities – countable and uncountable nouns

- *Plenty of* is another quantifier you can use with both types of noun.



• Don't rush. We have plenty of time.

• There are plenty of spaces in the car park.



[In the meeting, we had plenty of good ideas. ✓]

“

Large quantities – *many*

- We use *many* with **plural countable nouns**.
- We normally use *many* in **questions** and with **negatives**.
- For **positive statements**, we use *a lot of*, *lots of* or *plenty of*.



How many colleagues do you have?

I don't have many dresses for work.





Large quantities – much

- We use *much* with uncountable nouns.
- We normally use *much* in questions and negatives.
- For **positive statements**, we use *a lot of*, *lots of* or *plenty of*.



How much money did you sell your house for?

✓ [There isn't much daylight in winter.]





Much or many?

	MUCH	MANY
1. How <u>much</u> work do you have at the moment?	☒	☐
2. How <u>many</u> people will be at the meeting?	☐	☒
3. I don't have <u>many</u> options unfortunately.	☐	☒
4. I don't have <u>much</u> time today.	☒	☐
5. Is there <u>much</u> hope of us succeeding?	☒	☐
6. Are there <u>many</u> things left to do before we leave?	☐	☒



Large quantities – positive sentences



- We do use ***much*** and ***many*** in **positive** sentences in **formal** English.
- This is often in **books, newspapers** or **academic work**.



- There are **many** reasons why he lost the election.
- There is **much** unemployment in some cities.



Large quantities – other more formal quantifiers

- We use *a high number of* and *a large number of* for countable nouns.
- We use *a great deal of* and *a large amount of* for uncountable nouns.



✓
A large number of people went to the concert.

✓
[She has a great deal of work to do.





Fill the gap with the best quantifiers

What might these people say?

1. There are
many
things to
consider.



informal
2. There is
a lot of
money in that
wallet.



a lot of
3. There are
a number of
many
reasons why we
lost.



4. There has
been
a great deal of
doubt about the
resignation.



abstract



Small quantities – few

- We use few with plural countable nouns.
- Like many and much, we normally use few to express negative ideas.



• He has few friends in the city.

• There are few customers in the restaurant tonight.





Small quantities – *little*

- We use *little* with uncountable nouns.
- Like *few*, *little* expresses a negative idea.



There is little chance of rain. •

He has little interest in sport. •





Small quantities – a few and a little



- Notice there's a difference between *few* and *a few* and *little* and *a little*.
- *A few* and *a little* both mean *some* or *a small amount*.
- Compare the difference in meaning of these sentences:



[more] problems

• I've had a few problems at work recently.

[less] problems

• I've had few problems at work recently.





Small quantities – *a few* and *a little*



- Now compare these two other sentences:



I only eat a little food before I go to the gym.

enough

+



[There's little food for him to eat.]



not enough -- negative idea

smaller

more negative -- smaller





Fill in the gaps using few, a few, little or a little

a few / few

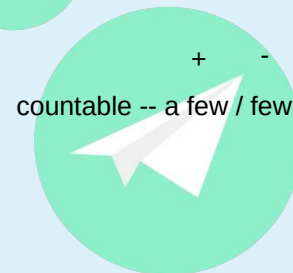
+ -

a little / little

uncountable

+ -

1. I have a little orange juice left. There's enough to share. + enough +
2. I have a few good friends. I wouldn't say I'm lonely. not enough -
3. He's received little training. He can't do anything for his job. not enough -
4. There are few colleagues that he actually gets on with at work. It's quite sad! not enough -
5. We've got a little bit of time tonight. Do you fancy meeting up? +
6. Fiona gave us a few tips for the presentation. They were so helpful! +
7. She has little belief in herself. She really needs some more confidence! not enough -
8. We see few female CEOs in our industry. This needs to change! negative -- not enough





Think of something or somewhere that has...

... only a few seats
inside.

... very little rain each
year.

... few problems
making calculations
quickly.

... a little fat in it.



Discussion

What do you think is more important to have: *lots* or *plenty of* in life? What's it better to have *few* or *little* of? Share your ideas as a group!



Money

Problems

Friends

Job satisfaction



Game!

- Guess how much time each member of the class spends doing these things every week.
- Then ask each member a question using the correct quantifier to find out the answer!





Reflect on the goals

Go back to the second slide of the lesson and check if you have achieved all the goals of the lesson.

yes

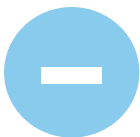
no





Reflect on this lesson

Think about everything you have seen in this lesson.
What were the most difficult activities or words? The easiest?



If you have time, go over
the most difficult slides again



Answer key 1/2

Exercise p. 6

Countable: cloud, room, chair, car

Uncountable: furniture, traffic, information, weather

Exercise p. 7

1. false 2. true 3. true 4. true 5. false 6. false

Exercise p. 12

1. much, 2. many, 3. many, 4. much 5. much 6. many

Exercise p. 15 – other answers are possible

1. There are **many** things to consider.

2. There is **a lot of** money in that wallet.

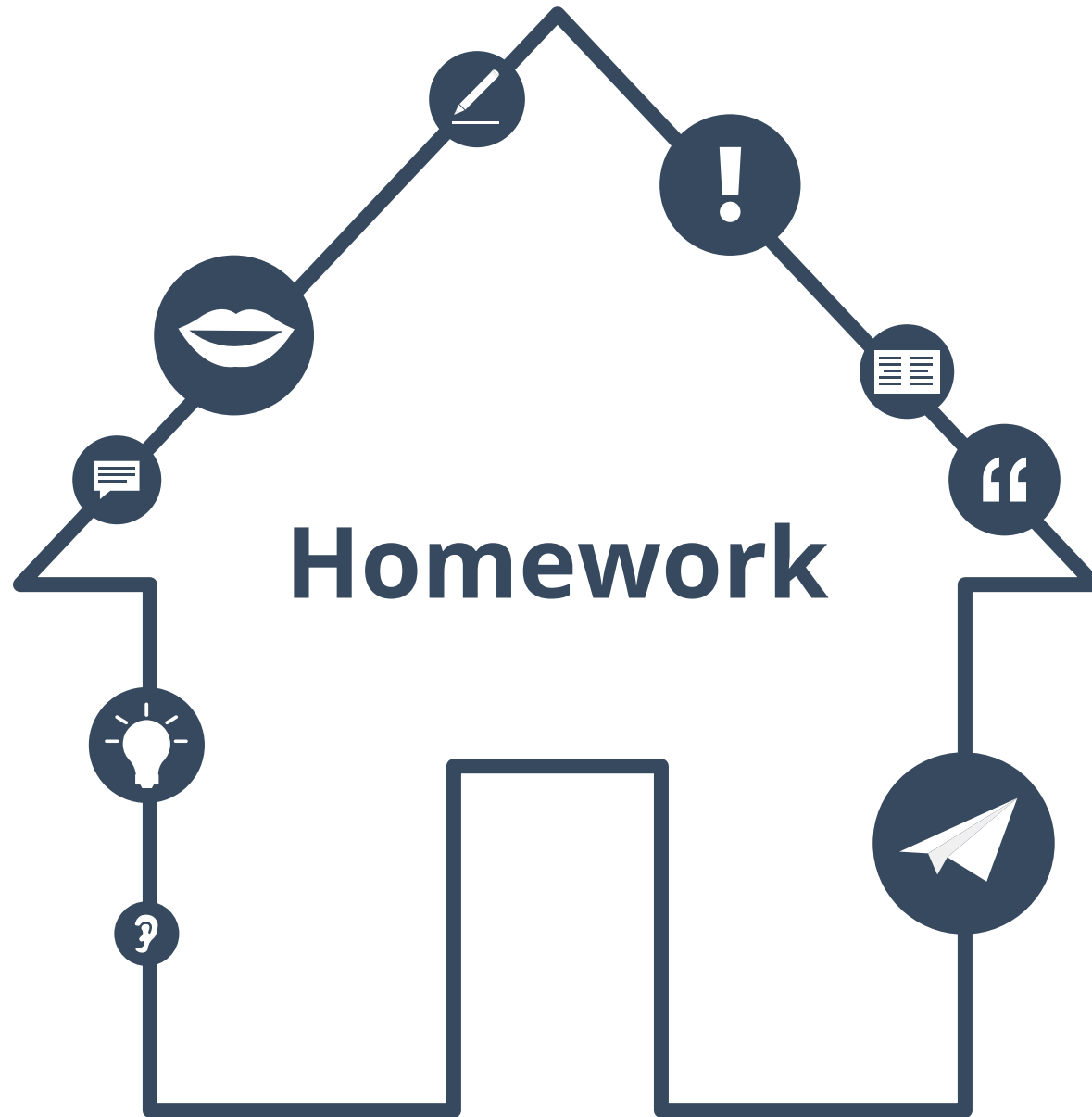
3. There are **a number of** reasons why we lost.

4. There has been **a great deal of** doubt about the resignation.



Answer key 2/2

- Exercise p.20**
1. a little
 2. a few
 3. little
 4. few
 5. a little
 6. a few
 7. little
 8. few





Categorise

countable

uncountable

few

many

a little

a few

little

much

a great deal of

a number of

a large amount of

a large number of



Writing

This image shows a single sheet of white paper designed for writing. On the left side, there is a vertical blue margin line. To the left of this margin line are ten circular punch holes, evenly spaced vertically. The main body of the page contains ten horizontal blue ruling lines, which are parallel to each other and extend across most of the width of the page. These lines are positioned such that they leave a small gap between the margin line and the first line, and another gap between the last line and the right edge of the paper.



Homework answer key

Exercise p. 27

Countable: many, a few, a number of, a large number of
Uncountable: much, a little, little, a great deal of, a large amount of



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